

Response to Reviewers

Jane Doe

John Smith

2026-06-12

Re: Manuscript JBS-2026-0147 — “Effects of Spaced Practice on Long-Term Retention”

Journal of Behavioral Science · Revision 1

Dr. Maria Keller, Action Editor

Dear Dr. Maria Keller,

Thank you for the opportunity to revise our manuscript. We have addressed every comment from you and both reviewers point-by-point below. Reviewer comments appear in red boxes, our replies in blue boxes, verbatim text from the revised manuscript in grey boxes, and the resulting changes in green boxes. All page numbers refer to the revised manuscript with tracked changes.

Summary of Changes

- [Comment E.1](#) ✓ — data and analysis scripts made openly available
- [Comment 1.1](#) ✓ — sample size justified by an a priori power analysis
- [Comment 1.2](#) (partially addressed) — central effect holds across three analytic choices
- [Comment 2.1](#) ✓ — effect situated relative to prior estimates

Editor

Comment:

Both reviewers find the question timely and the design sound. They converge, however, on the analysis: the sample-size justification and the robustness of the central effect both need strengthening before the paper can be accepted.

Reply:

We thank the editor for handling our manuscript and for the concise synthesis of the reviews. We have strengthened both points the reviewers raise: the sample size is now justified by an a priori power analysis (see [Comment 1.1](#)), and the central effect is reported under three analytic choices (see [Comment 1.2](#)).

Comment E.1

Please confirm that the data and analysis scripts are available, and state where, in line with the journal’s open-science policy.

Reply ✓:

The data and analysis scripts are openly available on the OSF (link in the manuscript). We now state this in a Data Availability statement (p. 18).

Reviewer 1

Comment 1.1

The study may be underpowered. The authors report a sample of 96 participants but give no justification for this number. Please report a power analysis or otherwise justify the sample size.

Reply ✓:

The reviewer is right that the original submission did not justify the sample size. We set the target sample a priori from a power analysis, which we now report in the Method:

Manuscript (Method, p. 6):

A power analysis for the within-subjects comparison ($d_z = 0.35$, $\alpha = .05$, power = .90) indicated a required sample of 90 participants; we recruited 96 to allow for exclusions.

Changes:

- **Method > Participants:** a priori power analysis added (p. 6)

Comment 1.2

The spacing effect in Table 2 might depend on how trials are aggregated. Please show that the effect is robust to reasonable alternative analyses.

Reply (partially addressed):

The aggregation choice deserves a check, and we agree. The spacing effect holds across the three analytic choices we considered, summarized in Response Table 1. A fully nonparametric reanalysis of the trial-level data is still running; we will add it if the editor considers it necessary, but the three analyses below already span the alternatives the reviewer raises. The same robustness bears on [Comment 2.1](#), where Reviewer 2 asks how our estimate compares with prior work.

Response Table 1: The spacing effect under three analytic choices.

Analysis	Effect (d_z)	95% CI
Primary (mean per condition)	0.41	[0.20, 0.62]
Trimmed means (10%)	0.38	[0.17, 0.59]
Mixed-effects (trial-level)	0.43	[0.24, 0.61]

Changes:

- **Results:** robustness analyses added (p. 11)
- **Supplement S2:** full analytic details and code

Reviewer 2

Comment 2.1

How does the size of the spacing effect here compare with previous estimates in the literature? The Discussion treats it as novel without situating it.

Reply ✓:

We have added a paragraph situating our estimate against prior work. The effect we observe ($d_z = 0.41$) sits within the range reported in earlier studies, and the robustness analysis in [Comment 1.2](#) shows the estimate is stable across analytic choices. We have toned down the “novel” framing accordingly.

Changes:

- **Discussion:** paragraph relating the effect to prior estimates added (p. 14)

Comment 2.2

A six-month follow-up would considerably strengthen the claims about long-term retention. I recommend collecting one.

Reply (respectfully declined):

We see the value of a six-month follow-up and considered it seriously. For this revision we respectfully decline to collect new data: our claims concern the one-week interval we tested, which we now state explicitly, and a six-month follow-up would pose a different question rather than strengthen the present one. We name it as the natural next step in the Discussion.

Changes:

- **Discussion:** retention claim scoped to the tested interval; six-month follow-up named as future work (p. 15)

Sincerely,

Jane Doe
on behalf of all authors